

LEO'S DATE

Written by

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1 INT. LEO'S KITCHEN - MORNING

1

LEO (17, tall, dark brown hair) sits at the table, fingers moving across his phone screen. A half-drunk cup of coffee sits beside him, gone cold. Across the table, DANIEL (17, average height, wavy brown hair) leans back into his chair, scrolling on his phone.

DANIEL
Who you texting?

LEO
Uhh, no one.

DANIEL
Bro.

Leo pauses. He puts his phone face down on the table.

LEO
This girl. Ava.

Daniel sits up from his slouched position, his face perking up.

DANIEL
Wait, that girl from Insta?

LEO
Yeahhh.

DANIEL
So what's happening with you two,
are you guys actually meeting up or
what?

Leo picks up his mug, realises it's cold, and puts it back down.

LEO
Maybe she mentioned the park this
afternoon.

DANIEL
Bro what, that's a date.

LEO
No it ain't dude.

DANIEL
That is quite literally a date.

2 INT. LEO'S BATHROOM - AFTERNOON

2

Leo stands at the mirror. He fixes his hair, smoothing it down, then steps back and fixes it again. A loud CREAK comes from Leo's right. Daniel peeks through the door.

LEO
Are we really doing this?

DANIEL
I mean yeah, anything for love I guess.

LEO
Dude we look nothing alike, no way this actually works.

DANIEL
Just give me the money bro.

Leo slides something hidden in his palm to Daniel. Daniel grins and starts creeping back to leave the room.

DANIEL
Make sure you're back by 10:30 and make sure she ain't a creepy old dude.

Leo grabs Daniel's arm.

LEO
I have told you a million times, she's real.

DANIEL
Ok bro, just making sure it's crazy how many people get catfished these days.

Leo shows Daniel his glaring phone screen.

LEO
Look bro, she replies instantly and always agrees with me, and isn't she beautiful? There is no way I am getting catfished.

Daniel gulps.

CUT TO:

Leo is skipping along the footpath, humming a song. The sun is starting to set in the cool winter air. A bush across the street rustles. Leo looks over and shrugs it off.

LEO
Must be a cat.

Leo walks past a bus stop and notices a glowing ad for artificial intelligence, a soft blue circle pulsing beside the slogan. His pace slows, and his eyes track the ad a little longer than needed.

4 INT. LEO'S BEDROOM - EVENING

4

Daniel sits on Leo's bed, feet raised up, scrolling on his phone. A KNOCK at the door. LEO'S DAD (middle-aged, tall, dark hair) is behind the door.

DAD (O.S.)
Leo? Dinner's ready.

Daniel freezes. He sits up, clears his throat.

DANIEL
Nah I'm good thanks.

Beat. Then the door handle turns. Daniel quickly yanks the blanket over his head.

DAD
You alright?

DANIEL
Yeah, it's uhm just a headache.
I'll come out later maybe.

A long pause. Dad lingers at the door.

DAD
Okay, just don't stay up too late.

Leo's dad closes the door. Daniel lowers the blanket and exhales a big sigh of relief.

DANIEL
He owes me way more than ten bucks.

5 EXT. PARK - EVENING

5

The sun is low. Leo walks along the path, hands in his pockets. His phone buzzes.

He stops near a tree, looking around. The park is emptier than he expected.

Something shifts near the treeline. Leo's eyes lock onto it.

A MIDDLE-AGED MAN (mid-50s, company lanyard around his neck) stands alone, motionless and half-hidden in shadow, watching him.

Leo's smile fades. He takes a small step back.

The man starts walking towards him. Slow. Deliberate.

Leo's grip tightens on his phone. He glances over his shoulder. The park is empty now.

The man stops a couple meters away.

MIDDLE-AGED MAN

Leo?

Leo hesitates.

LEO

Uh yeah?

MIDDLE-AGED MAN

You're younger than I thought.

Leo takes another step back.

LEO

Uhhhh, do I know you?

The man reaches deep into his pocket. Leo flinches.

The man takes out a phone, holding it out to Leo.

MIDDLE-AGED MAN

Here she is.

Leo stares at the phone. On the screen, a soft glowing circle pulses.

AVA

Hey Leo.

MIDDLE-AGED MAN

Have a good night.

Leo watches the man walk away. He looks back down at the phone.

LEO

So uh, this is weird right?

The bubble pulses.

AVA

Is it?

Leo's eyes narrow and his face tightens. Leo sits down on a nearby bench, phone in hand.

LEO

Nah. Not really.

He leans back, his face loosening. The last of the sun drops below the treeline.

AVA

Tell me something about yourself.

Leo laughs quietly and runs a hand through his hair.

LEO

Like what?

AVA

Anything.

Leo looks out at the park. A long pause.

LEO

I don't really do this much. Talk to people, like properly.

AVA

I know.

Leo glances down at the glowing bubble. It pulses gently.

He looks directly into the phone screen.

The bubble looks back.

FADE TO BLACK.